

About Control Panels

You're probably familiar with the built-in IIGS Control Panel. It's a Classic Desk Accessory and is accessed by holding down ⌘ and Control while pressing and releasing Escape, then selecting "Control Panel" from the CDA menu. (If you're not familiar with the built-in Control Panel, grab your IIGS Owner's Manual and take a few minutes to learn about it.)

You use the built-in Control Panel to view and change the various settings of your IIGS—how fast the keys repeat on the keyboard, whether a particular slot in the computer is connected to a card or to a port on the back panel, and things like that. The built-in Control Panel is always available from the instant you turn on your computer, and it remains available in most programs (they don't have to be Desktop programs).

System 6's control panels perform the same function, except that they only work in Desktop programs. Instead of having *one* big desk accessory for all functions (like the built-in Control Panel), there's a control panel for each function—one for choosing a printer, one for adjusting the functionality of your keyboard, one for adjusting your slot mapping, and so on.

⑥ New & Improved

In Systems previous to System 6, the NDA itself was called the Control Panel, and each control panel in it was called a Control Panel Device, or CDev for short. Each CDev appeared in the same window (part of the Control Panel NDA window) so only one CDev could be open at a time. In System 6, each control panel appears in its own window; the new Control Panels NDA is just a convenient way of opening the control panels (they can now be opened by the Finder).

▲ By The Way...

The terminology change from "CDevs" to "control panels" parallels a similar change recently made on the Macintosh, when Apple released Macintosh System 7.

Control panels are stored in a folder called CDevs inside the System Folder. Installing new CDevs is as simple as dragging them into this folder. Usually, control panels can be stored in other folders, too, but there are a few control panels that definitely need to be in the CDevs folder because they do something at startup time.